

Data Catalog User Guide

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APPROVAL SIGNATURES

Role	Name	Signature	Date
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1. INTRODUCTION

1.1 What is the Data Catalog?

The Data Catalog is Company A's enterprise metadata repository powered by Informatica Enterprise Data Catalog (EDC). It serves as the central hub for discovering, understanding, and governing all organizational data assets.

Key Capabilities

Capability	Description	Benefit
Data Discovery	Find data assets across 47 source systems	Reduce time searching for data
Data Lineage	Trace data from source to consumption	Understand data transformations
Data Quality	View quality scores and issues	Trust the data you use
Collaboration	Share knowledge with colleagues	Leverage organizational expertise
Access Requests	Request access to restricted data	Streamlined approval process

1.2 Who Should Use This Guide?

User Role	Primary Use Cases	Sections to Focus On
Data Analyst	Find and understand data for analysis	2, 3, 4, 5
Data Scientist	Discover datasets for ML models	3, 4, 5, 6
Data Steward	Curate and enrich metadata	4, 5, 6, 7
Report Developer	Find source data for reports	3, 4, 5
IT Developer	Understand data structures	3, 4, 5

Business User	Find trusted data for decisions	2, 3, 4
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1.3 System Requirements

Requirement	Specification
Browser	Chrome 90+, Edge 90+, Firefox 88+
Screen Resolution	Minimum 1280x720, Recommended 1920x1080
Network	Company A internal network or VPN
Authentication	Active Directory credentials (SSO)

2. GETTING STARTED

2.1 Logging In

Step-by-Step Login Process

Step	Action	Screenshot Reference
1	Open browser and navigate to https://catalog.compa	Figure 2.1
2	Click "SSO Login" button	Figure 2.2
3	Enter your network ID (e.g., a.alrashid)	Figure 2.3
4	Enter your password	Figure 2.3
5	Complete MFA verification if prompted	Figure 2.4
6	You will be redirected to the Catalog homepage	Figure 2.5

First-Time Users

- If this is your first login, you will see a welcome wizard:
- Accept the Terms of Use
 - Set your notification preferences
 - Select your primary domain of interest
 - Complete the 5-minute orientation tour (recommended)

2.2 The Homepage

Homepage Components

Component	Location	Purpose
Search Bar	Top center	Primary search entry point
Navigation Menu	Left sidebar	Access different sections
Most Viewed	Center panel	Popular assets this week
Recently Viewed	Right panel	Your browsing history
Announcements	Top banner	System updates and news
Quick Links	Bottom	Common tasks and help

Domain Navigation

Domain	Description	Asset Count
Clinical	Patient care and medical records	2,847
Financial	Billing, payments, revenue	1,234
Administrative	HR, operations, facilities	892
Research	Clinical studies and analytics	456
Supply Chain	Procurement and inventory	678

2.3 User Profile Settings

Configurable Preferences

Setting	Options	Default
Language	English, Arabic	English
Items per Page	10, 25, 50, 100	25
Email Notifications	Daily, Weekly, Off	Weekly
Default Search Scope	All, My Domains, Certified Only	All
Theme	Light, Dark	Light

3. SEARCHING FOR DATA

3.1 Basic Search

How to Search

1. Click in the search bar or press / (keyboard shortcut)
2. Type your search term (e.g., "Patient Demographics")
3. Press Enter or click the search icon
4. Review results organized by asset type

Search Results Overview

Result Type	Icon	Description
Table	■	Database tables and views
Column	■	Individual data fields
Report	■	BI reports and dashboards
Glossary Term	■	Business definitions
File	■	Data files (CSV, Excel, etc.)
API	■	Data services and endpoints

3.2 Filters (Facets)

Available Filter Categories

Filter	Purpose	Example
Resource	Filter by source system	Oracle EHR, SAP HR
Asset Type	Filter by data object type	Table, Column, Report
Domain	Filter by business domain	Clinical, Financial
Classification	Filter by sensitivity	PUBLIC, CONFIDENTIAL
Certification	Filter by trust level	Certified, Not Certified
Rating	Filter by user rating	4+ stars
Owner	Filter by data owner	Dr. Ahmed Al-Rashid
Last Updated	Filter by modification date	Last 30 days

How to Apply Filters

Step	Action
1	Perform a search

2	Look at the left panel for available filters
3	Click on a filter category to expand
4	Select one or more values
5	Results automatically refresh
6	Clear filters by clicking "Clear All"

3.3 Advanced Search Syntax

Search Operators

Operator	Syntax	Example	Result
Exact Match	"term"	"Patient ID"	Assets with exact phrase
Field Search	field:value	name:"Demographics"	Search specific field
Wildcard		card	Credit Card, ID Card
OR	term1 OR term2	Patient OR Member	Either term
AND	term1 AND term2	Patient AND Address	Both terms
NOT	NOT term	Patient NOT Test	Exclude term
Nested	(term1 OR term2) AND term3	(Patient OR Member) AND Active	Complex queries

Field-Specific Searches

Field	Syntax	Description
name	name:"Patient"	Search asset names only
description	description:"medical record"	Search descriptions
owner	owner:"Al-Rashid"	Search by owner name
system	system:"Oracle"	Search by source system
domain	domain:"Clinical"	Search by business domain
classification	classification:"CONFIDENTIAL"	Search by data class

3.4 Saving and Sharing Searches

Feature	How to Use
Save Search	Click "Save" icon, enter name, select folder

Load Saved Search	Click "My Searches" in navigation
Share Search	Click "Share" icon, enter colleague's email
Subscribe to Search	Click "Subscribe" for weekly updates

4. UNDERSTANDING ASSETS

4.1 Asset Page Overview

When you click on an asset, you see a detailed page with multiple tabs:

Tab	Content	Primary Users
Overview	Business description, metadata	All users
Columns	Field details and statistics	Analysts, Developers
Lineage	Data flow visualization	Stewards, Analysts
Quality	DQ scores and rules	Stewards, Analysts
Reviews	User comments and ratings	All users
Access	Permissions and requests	All users
History	Change log	Stewards

4.2 The "Overview" Tab

Key Information Displayed

Field	Description	Example
Name	Technical name of asset	PATIENT_DEMOGRAPHICS
Business Name	User-friendly name	Patient Demographics
Description	What the data represents	Core patient identity information
System	Source system	Oracle EHR Production
Schema	Database schema	CLINICAL
Owner	Responsible person	Dr. Ahmed Al-Rashid
Steward	Day-to-day curator	Sara Al-Mohsen
Classification	Data sensitivity	CONFIDENTIAL
Certification	Trust indicator	■ Certified

Last Updated	Metadata refresh date	October 1, 2024
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Certification Badges

Badge	Meaning	Criteria
■ Certified	Trusted for decision-making	DQ > 95%, complete metadata
■ Reviewed	Under steward review	Metadata complete, DQ pending
■ Uncertified	Use with caution	Incomplete metadata
■ Deprecated	Do not use	Scheduled for retirement

4.3 The "Columns" Tab

Column Information

Attribute	Description
Column Name	Technical field name
Business Name	User-friendly name
Data Type	VARCHAR, NUMBER, DATE, etc.
Length	Field size
Nullable	YES/NO
Primary Key	YES/NO
Foreign Key	Referenced table.column
Description	Field definition

Data Profiling Statistics

Statistic	Description	Example
Row Count	Total rows in table	18,547,293
Completeness	% non-null values	99.2%
Uniqueness	% unique values	100% (for IDs)
Min Value	Minimum value	1
Max Value	Maximum value	18547293
Top Values	Most frequent values	Riyadh (45%), Jeddah (28%)
Pattern	Detected format	###-###-####

4.4 The "Reviews" Tab

Review Components

Component	Purpose
Star Rating	1-5 star quality indicator
Written Review	Detailed feedback
Tips & Warnings	Usage recommendations
Questions	Q&A with steward

Example Reviews

Reviewer	Rating	Comment
Fatima K.	★★★★★	"Excellent data quality, well documented"
Omar S.	★★★★	"Good coverage, some nulls in address fields"
Nadia M.	★★★	"Date field is text format in 2020 records - conve

5. DATA LINEAGE

5.1 Understanding Lineage

Data lineage shows how data flows from source systems through transformations to final consumption points.

Lineage Terminology

Term	Definition
Source	Origin system where data is created
Transformation	Process that modifies or moves data
Target	Destination where data is consumed
Upstream	Data sources that feed into an asset
Downstream	Assets that consume from an asset

5.2 Reading the Lineage Graph

Graph Components

Component	Visual	Description
Source Systems	■ Blue box	Oracle, SAP, etc.
ETL Jobs	■ Yellow box	Informatica mappings
Staging Tables	■ Green box	Intermediate storage
Data Warehouse	■ Purple box	Analytical storage
Reports	■ Orange box	BI dashboards

Navigation Controls

Control	Action
Scroll	Pan the graph
Zoom +/-	Adjust zoom level
Fit to Screen	Show entire lineage
Expand Node	Show connected assets
Collapse Node	Hide connected assets
Focus	Center on current asset

5.3 Impact Analysis

How to Perform Impact Analysis

Step	Action
1	Navigate to the asset you plan to change
2	Click the "Lineage" tab
3	Click "Impact Analysis" button
4	Review downstream dependencies
5	Export impact report

Impact Report Contents

Section	Information
Summary	Total impacted assets count
Reports	List of affected dashboards
ETL Jobs	Mappings requiring updates
APIs	Services consuming the data
Users	People who access the data
Contact List	Stakeholders to notify

Use Case Example

Scenario: "I want to change the 'Gender' code from M/F to 1/2"

Impact Type	Count	Examples
ETL Mappings	3	m_Patient_Load, m_Gender_Lookup
Reports	5	HR Demographics, Patient Census
APIs	2	PatientService, DemographicsAPI
Total Stakeholders	12	See contact list

6. DATA QUALITY INSIGHTS

6.1 Quality Scores

Score Interpretation

Score Range	Rating	Meaning
95-100%	Excellent	Ready for critical decisions
85-94%	Good	Minor issues, generally reliable
70-84%	Fair	Review before use
Below 70%	Poor	Significant issues, use with caution

6.2 Quality Dimensions

Dimension	Description	Example Rule
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Completeness	Non-null values	Patient_Name NOT NULL
Accuracy	Correct values	DOB <= TODAY
Consistency	Cross-field validity	City matches Postal Code
Uniqueness	No duplicates	MRN is unique
Timeliness	Data freshness	Updated within 24 hours
Validity	Format compliance	Email matches pattern

6.3 Viewing Quality Details

Information	Location
Overall Score	Quality tab header
Dimension Scores	Quality tab breakdown
Failed Records	Quality tab drill-down
Trend Chart	Quality tab history
DQ Rules	Quality tab rules list

7. COLLABORATION FEATURES

7.1 Q&A Feature

Asking Questions

Step	Action
1	Navigate to asset page
2	Click "Q&A" tab
3	Click "Ask Question"
4	Type your question
5	Click Submit

The Data Steward receives an email notification and typically responds within 2 business days.

7.2 Adding Reviews

Review Guidelines

Do	Don't
Be specific and constructive	Make personal criticisms
Share tips for using the data	Share confidential findings
Note data quality issues found	Complain without details
Update reviews as things change	Leave outdated reviews

7.3 Following Assets

Subscribe to assets to receive notifications when:

- Metadata is updated
- Quality scores change significantly
- New reviews are posted
- Asset is certified/decertified

8. ACCESS MANAGEMENT

8.1 Requesting Access

Access Request Process

Step	Action
1	Find the asset you need
2	Click "Shopping Cart" icon
3	Select access level needed
4	Provide business justification
5	Click "Checkout"
6	Request routed to Data Owner

Access Levels

Level	Permissions	Typical Use
Read	View data only	Analysts, reporting

Write	Modify data	Data entry, corrections
Admin	Full control	System administrators

8.2 Request Status

Status	Meaning
Pending	Awaiting owner review
Approved	Access granted
Rejected	Access denied
Expired	Temporary access ended

9. TROUBLESHOOTING

9.1 Common Issues

Issue	Solution
Can't log in	Check VPN connection, verify AD credentials
Search returns no results	Broaden search terms, remove filters
Lineage not showing	Check if lineage scan completed
Slow performance	Clear browser cache, try different browser
Missing assets	Asset may not be cataloged yet

9.2 Getting Help

Resource	Contact
Help Desk	ServiceNow ticket, Category: Data Catalog
Catalog Team	datacatalog@companya.gov.sa
Training	See Training Portal for courses

APPENDIX A: KEYBOARD SHORTCUTS

Shortcut	Action
/	Focus search bar
Enter	Execute search
Esc	Close dialog
?	Show help
g + h	Go to homepage
g + s	Go to saved searches

APPENDIX B: GLOSSARY

Term	Definition
Asset	Any data object in the catalog
Certification	Trust designation by steward
Curation	Process of enriching metadata
Domain	Business area grouping
Facet	Search filter category
Lineage	Data flow visualization
Profiling	Automated data analysis
Steward	Person responsible for data quality

Document End

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